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Full coverage from across the nation and region C1

WEATHER

Sunny to partly cloudy today
with a high of 78.
Partly cloudy tonight
with a low of 58.
See Page A10.

P I T T S B U R G H

Tribune-Review

Vol. 113 No. 221 © Tribune-Review Publishing Co. 2001 ★★ 35 Cents

WEDNESDAY,
SEPT. 12, 2001
Pittsburgh Edition
Circulation: (412) 320-7914
Office: (412) 321-6460
Six Sections
54 Pages

pittsburghlive.com

Terror and disbelief

Attacks forever change America

By David Crary
and Jerry Schwartz

THE ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — In the most devastating terrorist onslaught ever waged against the United States, knife-wielding hijackers crashed two airliners into the World Trade Center on Tuesday, toppling its twin 110-story towers. The deadly calamity was witnessed on televisions across the world as another plane slammed into the Pentagon, and a fourth crashed in Somerset County, Pennsylvania.

"Today, our nation saw evil," President Bush said in an address to the nation last night. He said thousands of lives were "suddenly ended by evil, despicable acts of terror."

Said Adm. Robert J. Natter, commander of the U.S. Atlantic Fleet: "We have been attacked like we haven't since Pearl Harbor."

Establishing the U.S. death toll could take weeks. The four airliners alone had 266 people aboard, and there were no known survivors. At the Pentagon, about 100 people were believed dead.

In addition, a firefighters union official said he feared an estimated 200 firefighters had died in rescue efforts at the trade center — where 50,000 people worked — and dozens of police officers were believed missing.

No one took responsibility for the attacks that rocked the seats of finance and government. But federal authorities identified Osama bin Laden, who has been given asylum by Afghanistan's Taliban rulers, as the prime suspect.

Aided by an intercept of communications between his supporters and harrowing cell phone calls from at least one flight attendant and two passengers aboard the jetliners before they crashed, U.S. officials began assembling a case linking bin Laden to the devastation.

U.S. intelligence intercepted communications between bin Laden supporters. PLEASE SEE ATTACKS/A2



Spencer Platt/Getty Images

A fiery blast rocks one of the two towers of New York's World Trade Center on Tuesday. Both towers were hit by separate hijacked planes and later collapsed. The terrorist attack shook the country's sense of security, but the horror wasn't over yet.

City life will go on, but not as usual

By Eric Heyl
TRIBUNE-REVIEW

Pittsburgh's streets, schools and shops may look the same today as they do every other day, but no one in them will likely ever be the same.

The Golden Triangle was left a ghost town Tuesday, and all of greater Pittsburgh was shaken after unprecedented terrorist strikes in New York and Washington, D.C., and a related crash of a hijacked jetliner in Somerset County. But most local businesses, government offices, colleges and universities that closed early yesterday will reopen today.

After the city virtually shut down when hijacked planes crashed into the World Trade Center, the Pentagon and rural Somerset County, attention focused on aiding victims of the carnage.

At blood donation centers throughout western Pennsylvania, potential donors aiding the thousands of victims of attacks on the World Trade Center and the Pentagon faced at least a two-hour wait.

Around 3:30 p.m., more than 100 people were waiting inside the Central Blood Bank's Uptown headquarters, while about 30 others lined up outside. "There's not much you can do from so far away, but giving blood does a lot," said Emily Dornblaser, 18, a Pitt sophomore.

In Whitehall, traffic on Baptist Road had slowed almost to a standstill at 5 p.m. because of cars pulling in and out of the parking lot of the South Hills blood bank donor center. Normally, the donor centers close at 7 p.m., but a worker at the Whitehall center said they would stay open until at least 10.

Blood bank spokeswoman Deborah Ervin said officials were trying to determine how to get the blood to New York, since the Federal Aviation Administration has suspended all commercial flights. Ervin said workers could drive the blood there, or the blood bank might ask the National Guard to deliver it by air.

Allegheny County is aiding Som-

PLEASE SEE LIVES/A2

In Washington:



Mark Faram/AP-Navy Times

A priest prays over a wounded man outside the west entrance of the Pentagon as emergency workers mobilized to help the injured. Nine minutes after the second hijacked jet hit the World Trade Center, a third jet slammed into the west side of the Pentagon.

In Somerset County:



David Lloyd/AP

Firefighters and emergency personnel investigate the scene of the crash of United Airlines Flight 93 just north of the Somerset County Airport. The Boeing 757 was en route from Newark, N.J., to San Francisco with 45 people aboard.

In New York City:



Ernesto Mora/AP

Two women hold each other as they watch the World Trade Center towers burn. The twin 110-story towers — a staple of the Manhattan skyline — collapsed, along with another building in the complex. The death toll was still unknown.

Printed at NewsWorks, Warrendale.



Opposing views

► The Arab world shares mixed emotions following the tragedies in the United States. Story, C3.



Grounded

► Airline traffic was anticipated to resume by noon today at Pittsburgh International Airport after a shut-down ordered by the federal government. Story, C4.



Eerie feeling

► Pentagon attack came just after Defense Secretary Donald Rumsfeld's prediction that something was about to happen. Story, C6.